conjure images of how division operates in the United States through tactics of segregation and surveillance. They also share her vision for reunion: “And so we stand, once more, in Angela’s words, ‘at the crossroads on the path of liberation.’” The contributing writers mention her time in Germany, noting its epiphanal nature for her life: “What had begun as an escape from racist America grew to seem to her an exile from the struggle of her Black brothers and sisters in America. She returned home to join the struggle.” The short pamphlet closes with mention of literal walls and the symbolic connotations, around the peril she faces while in prison: “When her words echo far beyond these closed and soundproofed walls, then they seek to take her life. So for her, the life—the struggle, are one.”[47] Again, the harsh, repressive structure of prison is compared to the urgent imperative to transcend such boundaries.

The political biography was one of over a dozen pieces of writing that eventually cohered into Davis’s first published book collection, *If They Come in the Morning* (1971). In this book, Davis and her interlocutors more fully engage with walls in both philosophical and symbolic lexicons. Coedited with close friend and member of her defense committee Bettina Aptheker, *If They Come in the Morning* was pieced together while she was incarcerated in California awaiting trial. The book consists of writings about and from prisoners. The title was inspired by James Baldwin’s “An Open Letter to My Sister, Angela Y. Davis,” originally published in the *New York Review of Books* in November 1970 and reprinted in Davis and Aptheker’s volume. Baldwin lets his readers know he is writing from Europe and has returned presumably to Paris from a trip to Germany: “Since we live in an age in which silence is not only criminal but suicidal, I have been making as much noise as I can here in Europe. … In fact, have just returned from a land, Germany, which was made notorious by a silent majority not so very long ago. I was asked to speak on the case of Miss Angela Davis, and did so. Very probably an exercise in futility, but one must let no opportunity slide.”[48] Baldwin uses the example of Nazi Germany as a comparative context for the politics of incarceration. He compares her to “the Jewish housewife in the boxcar headed for Dachau, or as any of our ancestors, chained together in the name of Jesus, headed for a Christian land.”[49] Baldwin evokes the memory of the Holocaust to inform perspectives on black freedom struggles in the United States. Baldwin attempts to forge connections between Davis’s case and the historical relationship between freedom and repression.